



Ring Video Doorbell Wired

Amazon launched its cheapest smart doorbell (\$60), featuring a 1080p wide-angle camera and two-way audio. <http://dgit.in/feb21-69>



Thomson TVs

As part of its PATH series, Thomson has launched two smart TVs (42 & 43 inch), running on Android TV 9. <http://dgit.in/feb21-70>

Philips AC3059/65 Air Purifier

Function over form

Irespective of the time of the year, air purifiers have become a necessity. Severe pollution during winters, extreme dust during the summers and pollen during other times of the year make breathing an all-year-round challenge. There are many air purifiers out there that claim to purify air, but we're here to test just how well they do the job. Here we have the Philips AC3059 Air Purifier in for review. Let's see how it fares.

Build and design

Instead of a rectangle, this year's Philips AC3059 Air Purifier is a cylinder, pulling in air from the bottom and expelling it out the top. There is also a display and control panel embedded into the top. The power cord is hard-wired into the body and unfortunately, there are no wheels or carry-handles built into it. Thankfully, it isn't very heavy so it won't be too much of a chore to move around.

Filter arrangement

The Philips AC3059 Air Purifier does away with the older 2-filter rectangular combo for a singular 360-degree one. This filter houses both the HEPA filter and the activated carbon layer, which together come to remove not just particulate pollutants and also volatile organic compounds like formaldehyde, benzene fumes and more. While the 360-degree design is helpful in improving the amount of air being pulled in, the downside of a combined filter is that if one of the filters reach end of life, you're going to have to replace the whole thing. There's also a pre-filter in the form of the cover that goes to seal the filter into place, but in our testing, we didn't find it to be very effective. Opening the bottom up to



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Price
₹32,995

reveal the filter after 3 weeks of use revealed big bunches of dog and human hair stuck in the HEPA filter. Thankfully, HEPA filters get more effective once they're a little clogged versus brand new.

Performance

We tested the Philips AC3059 Air Purifier in three room sizes measuring 120 square feet, 160 square feet and a large 220 square-foot room. Ambient testing conditions were fairly poor, with high levels of pollutants all around, with the AQI maxed out at 500. Most countries define the AQI formula for themselves, and the one used by India caps the AQI at 500. In order to measure air quality, we use the Kaitera Sensedge, an industrial grade air quality monitor that delivers AQI numbers based on the Indian standard. To test the efficacy of any air purifier, it is placed in one corner of the room, with the Sensedge being placed in the diagonally opposite side. Here's how the air purifier performed in the mid-sized room.

The Philips AC3059 Air Purifier when used in our smallest test room was definitely very effective, bringing

the PM 2.5 levels into safe limits in roughly 20 minutes from starting. The largest room in the house, however, took much longer. In the event a door or window was cracked open, the small room was quickly cleansed again, however, even the smallest hint of a crack in the door of the largest test room severely slowed down the Philips AC3059 Air Purifier's progress.

The other interesting facts about using an air purifier is that as it turns out, you can't use in a completely sealed room. The result of doing so would be serious CO2 build-up, resulting in sleepiness and lethargy. It is important to keep CO2 levels low, which means opening up the doors and windows periodically, which results in a spike of pollutants. In our case, we had the Philips AC3059 Air Purifier running all day and all night, and its most noticeable benefit was while sleeping.

Verdict

The Philips AC3059 Air Purifier is a surprisingly effective air purifier, having been tested at one of the worst times of the year with respect to air quality. While the official price is ₹32,995, it can be had for as little as ₹24,000 on various e-tailer platforms. The new design leans more towards minimal and functional. While the air cleaning capabilities of the Philips AC3059 Air Purifier make it a good recommendation, do note that it is an air purifier that can get very loud. So we recommend running it in your bedroom for an hour or so before going to bed, so that when you do finally decide to retire, you can put it in quiet mode.

—Swapnil Mathur

SPECIFICATIONS

FILTER TYPE: HEPA | COVERAGE AREA: 500 sq ft | AIR FLOW LEVEL: 400 cu.m/hr | POWER CONSUMPTION: 230 W | DIMENSIONS: 40 cm x 20 cm x 20 cm | WEIGHT: 8.6 kg

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